

Week 1 · Day 2 · AWS Global Infrastructure

Map AWS Regions & Build Your Infrastructure Cheat Sheet

 Time

50 min

 Objective

Use the AWS Global Infrastructure map and console to document all Regions, identify the closest to Nigeria, and create a personal reference cheat sheet.

 Prerequisites — Complete Before Starting

AWS Free Tier account from Day 1 · GitHub account (free at github.com) OR Notion account (free at notion.so)

 Portfolio Goal — What You Will Post

Publish your Region cheat sheet as a GitHub Gist or Notion page — your first shareable cloud reference document.

Lab Steps

Step 1 Explore the AWS Global Infrastructure Map

1. Visit <https://infrastructure.aws> — the interactive AWS global map.
2. Identify all AWS Regions shown in Africa. Note: af-south-1 (Cape Town) is the primary option for West/Central African latency.
3. Click on the US East (N. Virginia) region — note how many Availability Zones it has.
4. Click on af-south-1 (Cape Town) — note its AZ count and available services.
5. Find the nearest Edge Location to Nigeria — check for locations in Lagos or West Africa.

Step 2 Use the Console to Verify Regions

1. Sign in to your AWS console.
2. Click the Region selector (top-right) — count the total number of regions listed.
3. Switch to af-south-1 (Cape Town). Note: some services may show as unavailable here.
4. Switch back to us-east-1 (N. Virginia) — this is the region with the most available services.
5. In the EC2 console, go to EC2 Dashboard. Note the Availability Zones listed for us-east-1.

Step 3 Build Your Region Cheat Sheet

1. Open a text editor, Notion, or Google Docs.
2. Create a table with columns: Region Name | Region Code | AZ Count | Key Services | Notes.
3. Fill in at least 6 rows including: us-east-1, us-west-2, eu-west-1, af-south-1, ap-southeast-1, sa-east-1.
4. Add a second section: 'Key Facts to Remember' with the 3 exam traps from your slides.
5. Add a third section: 'Nigeria Context' — latency to af-south-1, data sovereignty notes.
6. Save this as your permanent AWS reference document — you will add to it every week.

Step 4 Publish to GitHub Gist

1. Go to <https://gist.github.com>.
2. Paste your cheat sheet content. Title it 'AWS Regions Cheat Sheet — Week 1'.
3. Set visibility to Public. Click Create public gist.
4. Copy the URL — this is your first portfolio artifact link.



Screenshot Checklist

Take these screenshots and save them to your portfolio folder:

- ☐ AWS infrastructure map showing Africa region
- ☐ Console Region selector showing all available regions
- ☐ Your completed cheat sheet table
- ☐ Your published GitHub Gist URL



Portfolio Post — Copy & Customise

GitHub Gist description: 'AWS Regions reference sheet built during Week 1 of the AWS Cloud Accelerator course. Includes all regions, AZ counts, and Nigerian market notes. Part of my journey to SAA-C03 certification.'



Bonus Challenge — Push Your Skills Further

Use the AWS Latency Test tool (cloudpingtest.com) from your location and record the latency to af-south-1 vs us-east-1. Add these real numbers to your cheat sheet.



Lab Complete — Mark Off Your Progress

Lab Steps Completed



All Screenshots Taken



Portfolio Artifact Posted



Bonus Challenge Attempted

